Sara Licciardi

Department of Economics and Statistics
University of Naples Federico II
Citizenship: Italian ◇ E-mail ◇ Website ◇ Linkedin

Last Update: September 2026

Research Field

Macroeconomics; Monetary economics; Fiscal policy; Public economics

Education

Ph.D. in Economics — Naples, Italy
Naples School of Economics — 2024 – Ongoing
◇ Supervisors: Prof. Antonio Acconcia, Prof. Riccardo Silvestrini

Ph.D. Visiting Period — London, United Kingdom
London Business School — Sept 2026 – Ongoing
◇ Supervisor: Prof. Paolo Surico

M.S. in Economics and Finance — Rome, Italy
"La Sapienza" University of Rome — 2022 – 2024
◇ Cumulative GPA: 4.00, *Highest distinction*
◇ Thesis: *The policy–mix impact on inequality: A micro–based analysis*
◇ Supervisor: Prof. Valeria Patella; Co–advisor: Prof. Massimiliano Tancioni

Exchange Program — Bruxelles, Belgium
Université Libre de Bruxelles — Jan – Jun 2024

B.S. in Business Economics — Lecce, Italy
Department of Economics, University of Salento — 2019 – 2022
◇ Cumulative GPA: 3.93, *Highest distinction*
◇ Thesis: *Investing in education. Economic Theory and RRP Compared*
◇ Supervisor: Prof. Felice Russo

Work in Progress

Wage and Tax Bracket Erosion: Where Inflation Losses Fall

Abstract: This paper studies how inflation affects real after-tax earnings through the interaction of wage erosion and tax-bracket erosion. When tax brackets are imperfectly indexed, bracket erosion can amplify the transmission of wage erosion from before- to after-tax earnings, while increasing government tax revenues. Crucially, this amplification varies across the earnings distribution due to the tax schedule nonlinearity. A tractable model shows that the distributional incidence of inflation depends on two factors: workers' positions relative to tax thresholds and the relative degree of wage and tax-bracket indexation. Consequently, tax progressivity shapes the distribution of inflation losses, but, for a given degree of progressivity, the ranking of these losses across earnings can reverse depending on whether wage or bracket erosion dominates. To characterize these effects, I introduce two novel measures capturing incidence and dispersion of inflation-induced losses. The model highlights a policy trade-off between protecting real after-tax earnings, limiting the dispersion of inflation losses, and preserving tax revenues. I quantify the mechanism in the Italian institutional setting, where workers in the middle tax bracket experience the largest losses. Counterfactual analyses show that full tax-bracket indexation reduces tax revenues and shifts the incidence of inflation losses toward the lowest tax bracket. By contrast, partially indexing tax brackets more than wages can achieve distributional neutrality at a substantially lower fiscal cost.

Presented at: 7^{th} Naples Summer School of Economics and Finance, Poster session; 6^{th} Sailing the Macro Workshop 2026, Poster session; Ph.D. NSE internal seminar; 5^{th} Ph.D. and Post-Docs NSE Workshop; Bank of Italy Conference - 37^{th} SUERF Colloquium, Poster Session*

Time-Varying Policy with Andrea Ferrara and Francesco Simone Lucidi

Are You Series? Mining Temporal Rules From Financial Time Series with Livia Blasi, Eleonora Laurenza, Luigi Bellomarini, Emanuel Sallinger

Advanced Education

Numerical Methods for Fiscal and Monetary Policy Analysis — Barcelona, Spain
Barcelona School of Economics. Lecturer: Prof. Davide Debortoli — Jul 2025

Naples Summer School of Economics and Finance — Naples, Italy
Naples School of Economics — Jun 2025

- ◇ Behavioral Macroeconomics – Prof. Nicola Pavoni
- ◇ Historical Economics – Prof. Francesco Drago

Knowledge Graphs for Economics and Finance — Naples, Italy
Bank of Italy. Lecturer: Prof. Eleonora Laurenza — Jun 2025

Financial Time Series and High Frequency Econometrics — Bertinoro, Italy
Italian Econometrics Society & University of Salerno — Jun 2024

◇ Lecturers: Profs. Vincenzo Candila, Alessandra Amendola, Giovanni Bonaccolto

Difference–In–Differences and Event Study Estimators with Panel Data — Online
CEPR & EABCN — May 2024

Teaching & Working Experience

Economics Tutor, "La Sapienza" University of Rome — Rome, Italy
Microeconomics and macroeconomics teaching (undergraduate) — 2024

Junior Economist, City Hall — Lecce, Italy
Intern at the Economic and Financial Service — 2022

Academic Service

Ph.D. Representative — Naples, Italy
Ph.D. Quality Management Unit, NSE — 2025 – Ongoing

Workshops, Conferences

◇ **Member of the Organizing Support Team** – 6^{th} Sailing the Macro Workshop — 2026

◇ **Organizer, Peer Reviewer** – 5^{th} NSE Ph.D. and Post-Doctoral Workshop — 2026

◇ **Peer Reviewer, Session Chair** – 4^{th} NSE Ph.D. and Post-Doctoral Workshop — 2025

Awards & Grants

Ph.D. Scholarship
Naples School of Economics — 2024 – Ongoing

Best Master Student and Thesis Innovation Award
Fondazione Roma Sapienza — Nov 2024

Summer School SiDE Scholarship
Bank of Italy — Jun 2024

Exchange Program Grant
"La Sapienza" University of Rome — Jan 2024

M.S. Scholarship & Premio Laurea
DiSCO Lazio — 2022 – 2024

B.S. Scholarship
ADISU Puglia 2019 – 2022

Other Activities

Voluntary for Education, Save the Children Lecce, Italy
Math teaching for secondary school students 2022

Languages

Italian: Mother tongue

English: Proficient

Spanish: Intermediate

French: Intermediate

Skills

Programming: Python, MATLAB, Dynare, Stata

LaTeX: Overleaf

Microsoft Office Suite: Word, Excel, PowerPoint

References

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